KIN BJJ Overview

The goal in creating a successful kids martial arts program is to focus on developing the students' foundational skills and values that will help them to grow as individuals. Much like building a house, a strong foundation based on values such as respect, discipline, perseverance, humility, restraint, and loyalty, etc, will help the child to develop into future stewards not only for the art of jiujitsu, but for the community as a whole. We use the art of bjj as a tool to help guide these kids into the absolute best versions of themselves. When most people think of martial arts, they often think only of physical capacity, but we are teaching/raising students through a holistic approach to life that develops not only the body, but the mind and spirit as well. This way, our students are physically strong, mentally flexible, and emotionally stable. This should be the ultimate goal of any martial arts kids program.

The supplementary programs that can be contained outside, but under the umbrella of the main kids programs are:

- Self Defence Program (Separate curriculum from sport)
- Ambassadors Program (Anti bullying/Life skills, etc)
- Future coaches Program (Assistant coach program)
- Head start Program (3-4 year old prep class)

Each of these programs have a separate grading/certification process independent of the traditional BJJ kids belt system and would require a full build out. Gi patches and certificates are how certification can be awarded.

These additional programs also help the student learn real world skills that will help them over their lifetime. Some of the most important skills an individual can possess is discernible judgement, decision making abilities, awareness, leadership, team work, etc. A keen mind allows them to assess any challenge in front of them and make appropriate decisions. These skills will give them the tools they need to build a successful life. Success is not by accident. It is by design…..

KIN BJJ Overview

Future Black Belt Program

- Longer term option when time and space permit

Students that wish to challenge themselves and to take the next step in their training should consider upgrading to the FBB Program. This separate program will give them access to the more advanced training program along with additional classes. It is important to use a different colored gi to signify the commitment of the student and to give new students something to aspire to. Students enrolled in this program will be given a blue colored gi, signifying their commitment to BJJ and training. This allows you to price the starter class at a lower class and use the FBB program as a means to incentivise parents on the more expensive program. Options for this program can include additional training days during the week or invite to open mat sparring sessions.

Class Structure

It's important to adhere to a basic format on how the structure is taught. Curriculum is as important, and is covered elsewhere, but if there isn't a systematic infrastructure on how the material is delivered, your results will not be as consistent. There is a fair amount of research done on how humans learn new skills, so it would make sense to apply those techniques to the bjj curriculum.

The research has clearly shown that a great portion of learning comes from motivation and passion. By cultivating an environment where your students are engaged and challenged, yet having fun, you are in turn cultivating an environment where maximum learning can take place. This comes before we even consider technical content and the delivery systems which will be covered later.

For children under the age of around 7, a 30 minute class is most appropriate. As they get older, you can push to a 45min -1 hour class. As you move to a longer class, more drilling can be included, with the mat chats, and games taking the same amount of time.

Maintaining a firm, but not rigid class structure is critical in maintaining order and control of the class. Children will continually test boundaries and it is vital to establish what is and isn't acceptable behavior in the class. If a child shows up late, make them wait on the edge of class until you allow them to join the class. If they misbehave, exclude them from the class for a period of time until you allow them to rejoin. On the flip side, highlight the child that is showing the most desirable behavior and reward them. This shows the other kids what you want to see and the class will mold them.

KIN BJJ Overview

Youth: Ages 8 - 13.

- Kids will be assessed individually based to measure suitability for the program. The ages are used as guidelines only.

Basic overview: Class length: 60 mins

Below is an example of a typical class structure. This template can be used as a rough guide.

- Bow in, announcements, welcome new students. (2-3 mins)
    - Short as possible
- Warm up. (5 mins)
    - Topic specific movements
    - Focus on fundamental movements and basic skill development
- Takedown lesson
    - Short, concise material. 2 x 3 min lessons
    - Add additional content for senior student groups
- Takedown drill
    - Multiple rounds, specific to the class lesson
- Ground technique lesson
    - Short, concise material. 2 x 3 min lessons
    - Add additional content for senior student groups
- Ground technique drilling
    - Positional/goal based drilling. Specific to class material
- Positional/Open sparring
    - Target ⅓ of the class.
    - Multiple partners, minimum down time
- Bow out/Student of the day/Strip promotions. (2-3mins)

The total time above should reach 60 mins. Each lesson section should be no longer than 3 minutes, but I will break the lesson into two sections: One to show the technique and to let the students attempt it. And two, to observe and call back to correct common mistakes. The remainder of time is used to set up drills, break out groups, call ups, group resets, etc. Keep this time to a minimum and ensure that the students respond quickly to your requests otherwise it will throw off the pace of the class. I cannot stress this enough.

More info on developing a lesson plan from the curriculum can be found here:

KIN BJJ kids lesson plan structure

BJJ Instructor Lesson Plan Template

KIN BJJ Overview

Bjj Promotions

Kids will receive one stripe for (approximately) every 20 classes. The Head coach (black belt) will give belt promotions. Promotions for the kids program are based on a combination of the 4 "A" model: **Attendance, Ability, Attitude, Assistance** (helping others). Parents should be notified in advance for promotions so that they can attend and take photos. For belt promotions, students will be sent home with a notice to promote form to be filed out by their parents and students. The form will ask questions around behaviour and work ethic at home and in the classroom. This highlights our commitment in helping to grow respectable, dedicated, well adjusted students both on and off the mats.

Roll Call

Highest ranking student line up left to right

Announce any additions to the class and introduce any new students. Once they have signed up, promote them to white belt. Positively preframe the class by saying something like "You guys ready to have some fun?" or "Who wants to get closer to becoming a black belt?"

Warm ups

The goal of the warm up is simply to set the tone and structure for the class, incorporate new students into the group, and to get the students used to moving their bodies in fundamental methods.

Give the opportunity to assistant coaches for the honour of running the warm up if possible. This helps them to be comfortable in front of a group and to find their own "coach voice". Keep the warm up short, (approximately 5 mins), energy high, and moves relevant to the course material covered during the week where possible. (For example, If teaching double leg takedowns, have the students practice duck walks)

This is also the best time to get the students to watch and emulate the fundamental movements of jiujitsu (ie-shrimping, bridging, breakfalls, etc) without having to spend specific time teaching them one on one if you don't have a separate intro class.

KIN BJJ Overview

Takedown/Ground technical lesson

When a new technique is being shown to a class, it should be delivered in the following manner: This model applies to the adult program as well.

- Demonstrate the technique in real time
- Demonstrate the technique slowly and breakdown each movement (keep specifics short, and focus on the main movements. Small adjustments and details can be added later and will confuse the students in the short term)
- Show the technique no more than 3 times
- Allow the students to try the technique for 1 round
- Bring the students back to correct common mistakes
- Students drill the technique again under minimal resistance
- Drill again under progressive resistance model

Sparring

Make sure to pair up students with partners that you feel are most appropriate. Each class will vary, as will the skill set, experience, age, and sizes within the group. If there are no even matches, try pairing up a more senior, smaller student, with a larger, more junior student to balance out the match. The focus should be on positional, focused sparring based on the course material of the week.

Leave time for open sparring matches to prepare the students for what a competition style match will look like. Students with at least 1 stripe on their belts can start from standing and roll to submission based on the coaches approval. New white belt students should stick to positional sparring until they understand the basics of movement, breakfalling, and tapping to submissions. Always take time to preface the sparring session with a chat about spatial awareness, how and when to tap, and how to safely apply submissions. Ask them who the most important person in the gym is?

The answer is: **Your training partner.** Have them repeat this.

KIN BJJ Overview

Strategy

Students should understand first and foremost, the strategy and goals of a match. Blindly showcasing techniques does not help them understand the fundamentals of a typical BJJ/grappling match. Discuss at lengths (where appropriate) and guide them to an understanding of strength through structure, application of leverage, and positional hierarchy. Submission is the final piece of the puzzle. Always strive to keep the instruction simple, concise, and easy to understand. The focus should be primarily on concepts over techniques.

Weekly curriculum will be assembled from the rotating curriculum with one takedown and one specific ground technique for each week. During drilling, I always strive to implement movements and kuzushi that get the students training the muscle memory connection without overloading them and fogging up the glass, so to speak.

Take some time to break down the techniques during the technical portion of the class and allow them to practice at their own pace, but when it comes to drilling, it should be goal focused. The students will quickly learn what works and what doesn't and will approach you with questions you already have answers for. Some things will need to be discovered on their own to truly conceptualize.

Always read the room when it comes to technical lessons as well. When you start losing the attention of the class, stop immediately and get them moving.

IBJJF Point system (Taken from IBJJF)

As the majority of tournaments focus on this rule set, it's vital that our students and coaches have a thorough understanding of the point system along with the specific rules utilized by IBJJF. We don't need to bog the kids down with specifics (at least at first), but they should understand the basics below. When you are showcasing techniques that would score points, it's the perfect opportunity to test their knowledge and reinforce strategies.

- **Takedowns: 2 points**
- **Knee ride: 2 points**
- **Guard Pass: 3 points**
- **Mount: 4 points**
- **Rear mount: 4 points**

Have them acknowledge that each position must be held for 3 seconds to score and how the progression works.

KIN BJJ Overview

Negative Points

There are some instances when a competitor may receive negative points. The most important things you need to note to avoid penalty are the following:

- Never place four fingers inside the pants or sleeves
- Avoid stalling tactics—the referee will most definitely notice, and you will get penalized.

There are also other conditions that may earn you penalties, such as restricted attacks. The list of illegal moves is pretty extensive but tapers down as your rank goes up.
In the event that nobody has completed a submission in the allotted time frame, the point system comes into play to identify the winner. Unsurprisingly, the result is that the IBJJF is no stranger to stalling tactics from players trying to win through points. It's an inevitable consequence of the point system.

Advantage Points

If nobody completes a submission or scores any points during a match, advantage points come into play as a last resort. Advantage points go to players who *almost* scored. An example is if you got into a position but couldn't hold it for three seconds, or you couldn't take someone down, but they were visibly unbalanced.

That said, it is important to remember that advantage points only apply when nobody scores. It doesn't matter if your opponent has countless advantages. If you score even just one point, you still win.

Advantage Points

- Awarded for "almost" scoring, such as reaching a position but failing to hold it for the required 3 seconds.
- **Tie-Breaker Only:** Advantages are only used to determine a winner if no regular points are scored. Even a single regular point outweighs any number of advantages

Illegal Moves

It goes without saying that any illegal moves should be removed from the curriculum. Below is the list from IBJJF that details illegal submissions at each level. This list is selected due to the high risk of injury associated with each submission. Although not on the list, jumping guard and knee sitting off the single leg must also be discussed and restricted at the club level for student safety reasons.

KIN BJJ Overview

TABLE: Technical Fouls – Illegal Moves

	4 to 12 years old	13 to 15 years old	16 & 17 years old (all ranks) and white belts (Adult to Master 7)	Adult to Master 7 (blue & purple belts)	Adult to Master 7 (brown & black belts) exept Adult No Gi	Adult (brown & black belts) No Gi	
1	●						Submission techniques stretching legs apart
2	●	●					Choke with spinal lock
3	●	●					Straight foot lock
4	●	●					Forearm choke using the sleeve (Ezequiel choke)
5	●	●					Frontal guillotine choke
6	●	●					Omoplata
7	●	●					Triangle (pulling head)
8	●	●					Arm triangle
9	●	●	●				Lock inside the closed guard with legs compressing kidneys or ribs
10	●	●	●				Wrist lock
11	●	●	●				Single leg takedown while the attacking athlete has his head outside his opponents body. (**)
12	●	●	●	●			Bicep slicer
13	●	●	●	●			Calf slicer
14	●	●	●	●			Knee bar
15	●	●	●	●			Toe hold
16	●	●	●	●	●		Heel hook
17	●	●	●	●	●		Locks twisting the knees.
18	●	●	●	●	●		Knee Reaping (See definition in page 32)
19	●	●	●	●	●		In straight foot lock, turning in the direction of foot not under attack.
20	●	●	●	●	●		In toe hold, applying outward pressure on the foot
21	●	●	●	●	●	●	Slam
22	●	●	●	●	●	●	Spinal lock without choke
23	●	●	●	●	●	●	Scissor Takedown
24	●	●	●	●	●	●	Bending fingers backwards
25	●	●	●	●	●	●	Grab the opponents belt and throws him to the floor on his head when defending a single leg situation while his opponents head is on the outside of his body.
26	●	●	●	●	●	●	Suplex takedown technique, landing with the opponent's head or neck on the ground.

Students must understand the goals and strategies of a BJJ match. The majority of the training that we focus on during the regular class schedule revolves around specific, technical positions, however, I want to ensure that the students do not get myopic in their execution of technical movement. Although we may often study positions independently, a confident BJJ player must unconsciously flow between positions seamlessly, without a fixed starting and ending point. Focus the instruction on goals and strategy. Give your students clear direction

KIN BJJ Overview

Basic structure of a BJJ match (strategy perspective)

- **Stance** - Combat stance ready. One foot forward, One foot back. Knees bent. Hands up, elbows in. Shoulders on top of hips. Eyes forward. Back straight
- **Grip fighting -** Hand fight, Defend dominant grips like collars and any head control. Do not let your opponent break your posture. Look for two on one or inside position before advancing to takedown or clinch range
- **Takedown -** Setup takedown after superior grip, angle, and leverage is in play. There are 4 steps to a takedown:
    - Getting a firm grip (Kumi Kama)
    - Off balancing opponent (Kuzushi)
    - Getting into position (Tsukuri)
    - Executing the throw (Kake)
- **Control lower body -** Secure lower body control to prevent opponent from regaining standup position
- **Pass legs -** Utilize the various passing types to move past the legs
- **Secure bottom control (upper body)** Once the legs are out of play, secure and isolate the upper body. For example, block out the inside hip, isolate inside arm, cross face, far side underhook, chest pressure, far side hip control
- **Shutdown reguard options -** 3 methods to block the inside hip: your hip, arm, or knee.
- **Advance position -** Move through positional hierarchy to obtain points and to achieve a more dominant position.
- **Submission -** Submissions will present themselves through a combination of pressure and technical isolation.

The structure above is BJJ 101. Although there are multiple ways to win a match, (such as sweeps and submissions from bottom) this strategy is proven time and again and is most effective with the younger players who compete in shorter matches and struggle to regain point deficits. As we develop our guard play, we can expand into alternative options such as guard pull strategies after obtaining proper connection.

- **Stance**: Same as above
- **Grip fight:** Same as above
- **Guard pull**
    - Attack posture, break opponent down to weaker position
- **Sweep**
    - Use of leverage and kuzushi to sweep opponent
    - Stabilize in top position and work from there
- **Or/ Submission**
    - Finish the match from the bottom through application of submission technique

KIN BJJ Overview

Movement structure

Fundamental movements should be captured mainly in the warmups. Teaching the students to move their bodies in functional patterns that will transfer directly when techniques are layered on top and is an approachable way for brand new students to develop basic kinesthetic awareness. Try to select movement patterns that are relevant to the lesson plan of the week.
These movement patterns can be hidden in fun games and drills to make it more exciting. For example, turn a basic shrimping drill into a relay race to build cooperation and team spirit, and announce the winner. Having a white board with a leaderboard of drills in a fun way to give the students something to aspire to and to drive friendly competition.

Warm up move examples

- **Shrimping**: Power, Bottom leg drag/push, forward
- **Break falls**: Forward roll, front, side, rear
- **Bridging**: Side to Side, Bridge to turtle,
- **Sit out:** Turtle to sit out
- **Core drills**: Boat rocks, salsa
- **Takedown drills**: duck walks, sprawls
- **Guard drills**: butt scoot, triangles, hip drops, inverts
- **Scramble drills**: sit outs, bear crawls, technical get up

Dive rolls:

- From the knees
- From Standing
- Jumping over obstacles

Base drills

- Arm pull
- Head snap down
- push
- tree climb

Grip fighting

- Block/parry
- Breaking
- Strip and re grip

KIN BJJ Overview

Inside position

- Elbows
- Head
- Hips
- Shoulders

Wedges

- Cross face
- Underhook
- Reverse crossface
- Reverse underhook

The natural progression of skill acquisition on the ground is to survive, pin/control, escape, develop the guard, passing, submission.

Below we explore each of the major pin positions through a lens of 4 criteria for both top and bottom:

- **Secure/control -** The use of grips, positioning, and leverage to maintain the pin position
- **Advance/Transition -** The act of moving from one position to another, potentially more dangerous position for attacking, or transitioning as a means to maintain top position.
- **Attack/submission -** The final stage of the match where positional dominance is assured and a submission is applied to end the match.
- **Escape options (covered separately)**
    - **Stabilize/Structure -** The concept of establishing frames and proper posture
    - **Escape/Recover -** Moving from a structurally sound position to get your legs between you and your opponent and to reestablish a guard.
    - **Reverse/Transition -** moving directly from a bottom side position to top, often through an explosive bride movement, or quickly transitioning to a dominant position once the escape is complete

The basic fundamental positions are detailed below:

KIN BJJ Overview

Side Control

In BJJ, side control is a dominant pinning position where you are on top of your opponent, positioned perpendicular to them, forming a "T" shape. Your chest is pressed against their chest, and your legs are positioned away from theirs to prevent them from catching you in a guard.

It is considered one of the most stable control positions because you aren't attached to their legs or torso in a way that allows them to easily use their lower body power against you.

Traditional Side Control (Cross Face & Underhook)

The gold standard for pressure and control.

- **Secure/Control:** Drive the shoulder into the jaw (Cross Face) and pull the far arm up (Underhook). Keep knees tight to the hip and shoulder.
- **Advance:** Step over to Mount or "Windshield Wiper" to the other side.
- **Attack:** Paper Cutter Choke, Straight Armlock, or Bread Cutter.

Both Arms Far Side (Wrestler's Pin/Double Under)

Focuses on killing the hip and shoulder mobility simultaneously.

- **Secure:** Both arms reach under the opponent's far side (under the neck and under the far armpit). Lock hands or "Grip the Mat."
- **Advance:** Transition to North-South or Kesa gatame.
- **Attack:** Less offensive, but great for "Cooking" the opponent.

Overhook / Near Side Hip (Modified Side Control)

Used when the opponent is successfully framing against your neck.

- **Secure:** One arm overhooks the far arm, the other hand blocks the near-side hip to prevent them from bringing their knees in.
- **Advance:** Transition to North-South or reverse Kesa gatame
- **Attack:** Near-side Kimura or Spinning Armbar.

KIN BJJ Overview

Cross face/Near Side Hip

A strong option to prevent someone that is bridging hard into you.

- **Secure:** Chest-to-chest, strong cross face, block the inside hip/grab the pants under the hips
- **Advance:** Transition back to **Traditional Side Control** or force a back take
- **Attack:** North-South Choke or Kimura.

Kesa Gatame (Scarf Hold)

High pressure, classic Judo pin.

- **Secure:** Sit through, head low, pulling the opponent's near-side elbow off the floor. Keep your ribs heavy on their chest.
- **Advance:** Step over the head to **Back Take** or transition to **Mount**.
- **Attack:** Kesa Gatame Armlock (using your legs) or the Ezekiel Choke.

Reverse Kesa Gatame (Twister Side Control)

Facing the opponent's legs; excellent for neutralizing the guard.

- **Secure:** Sit through facing the legs. One arm hooks the far side hip/leg, the other controls the near arm.
- **Advance:** Easily step over into **Mount** or take **The Back**.
- **Attack:** Calf Slicer or Leg Locks (for advanced/adults) or "The Step-Over Armbar."

KIN BJJ Overview

Mount

The mount is arguably the most recognizable position in grappling, representing the ultimate dominance in a self-defense scenario because of the gravity-assisted striking and submission potential.

Secure

- **Low Mount:** Hips heavy on the opponent's hips, feet tucked or "grapevined."
- **High Mount:** Sliding the knees up into the opponent's armpits to isolate the head and arms.
- **Technical Mount (S-Mount):** A seated variation used when the opponent turns to their side; one knee is behind the head, the other foot is flat by their hip.
- **Closed/Grapevine:** Weaving your legs through theirs to "anchor" yourself against their bridging power.
- **Double unders mount:** Both arms are controlled through underhooks, completely removing them from defensive usage.

Attack

- **Cross Collar Choke:** Using the Gi lapels to create a powerful "X" across the neck.
- **Armbar (Juji Gatame):** Transitioning to High Mount, leaning over, and swinging the leg over the face.
- **Mounted Triangle:** Isolating one arm and locking the legs behind the opponent's neck.
- **Ezekiel Choke:** Using your own sleeve and fist to create pressure on the windpipe or carotid.
- **Americana:** Pinning the wrist and elbow to the mat in a "figure-four" lock.

Advance / Transition

- **Back Exposure:** If the opponent turns away to avoid strikes or the Mount pressure, follow their movement to take **Rear Mount**.
- **Transition to Knee on Belly:** If the opponent is about to recover guard, pop up to a "Neon Belly" to maintain pressure and mobility.
- **S-Mount Isolation:** Advancing from a Traditional Mount to a Technical Mount to isolate the arm for a finish.

KIN BJJ Overview

Rear Mount/Back control

Rear mount (often used interchangeably with back control) is one of the most dominant positions in BJJ, where you are behind your opponent with your chest against their back. It provides maximum offensive capability while leaving the opponent with virtually no weapons to counter-attack.

- **Secure**
  - **Seatbelt:** One arm over the shoulder (choking arm), one arm under the armpit (control arm). Grip your own hands in a "Gable Grip" or "Hidden Hand" grip.
  - **Double Hooks:** Feet tucked into the inside of the opponent's thighs. **Important for kids:** Remind them *never* to cross their ankles (to avoid the ankle lock counter).
  - **Body Lock (Body Triangle):** One leg across the stomach, the other leg hooking your own shin. This provides maximum torque and prevents the opponent from turning.
- **Attack**
  - **RNC (Rear Naked Choke):** The classic "Mata Leão." Hide the fingers and squeeze the elbows together.
  - **Sliding Collar Choke:** Using the opponent's own Gi lapel to create a "bow and arrow" or "loop" effect.
  - **Rear Triangle:** Transitioning from the back when an arm is isolated, locking the legs around the neck and one arm.
  - **Armbar (Juji Gatame):** Falling to the side while keeping the head trapped, transitioning the top leg over the face to finish the extension.
- **Advance**
  - **Truck/Twister Roll:** If the opponent successfully clears a hook, transitioning into "The Truck" to attack the legs.
  - **Mount Transition:** If the back is being lost and the opponent is turning into you, "Chair Sitting" or stepping over to stabilize **Full Mount**.
  - **Technical Mount:** Sliding into a high-S-Mount if the opponent turns to their side to escape.

KIN BJJ Overview

North-South

The ultimate "heavy pressure" pin that neutralizes the hips.

Secure

- **Chest-to-Face:** Your solar plexus should be directly over their face or upper chest to limit their breathing and vision.
- **Over-Under or Double Under:** Wrap your arms under their armpits and lock your hands, or grip the floor to create an anchor.
- **Sprawl and Heavy Hips:** Keep your knees off the mat and your weight on your toes to drive all your mass into their diaphragm.
- **Head Control:** Use your ribs to pinch their head so they cannot turn it left or right.

Attack

- **North-South Choke:** Wrap one arm around the neck, drop your shoulder into their throat, and sprawl back to create the strangulation.
- **Paper Cutter (Bread Cutter):** Transition one hand to the far-side lapel while the other arm anchors under their near-side armpit; drop the elbow to the mat across the neck.
- **Kimura:** If they reach up to frame your hips, isolate the arm, figure-four your grip, and rotate toward their head.
- **Spinning Armbar:** Use the North-South position to isolate an arm, then "windshield wiper" your legs over the head to finish.

Advance

- **Back Take:** If they turn to their side to escape, use a "Chair Sit" to take the back.
- **Transition to Side Control:** Walk your hips 90 degrees to return to traditional side control if they start winning the hand-fight.
- **The Mount:** Slide your knees over their shoulders and down into a "High Mount" or "S-Mount."

KIN BJJ Overview

Knee on Belly (Knee Ride)

The bridge between Side Control and Mount that emphasizes pressure and transition.

Secure

- **The "Placement":** Your near-side knee goes across the opponent's solar plexus; your far-side leg is posted wide for balance (the "kickstand").
- **Grips:** One hand on the collar (pulling up) and one hand on the belt or hip (pushing down) to create "sandwich" pressure.
- **Stay on Your Toes:** Do not put your posting foot flat. Stay on the ball of the foot to remain mobile.
- **Shoulder Posture:** Keep your chest up and back straight to maximize the weight driving through your knee.

Attack

- **Near-Side Armbar:** If the opponent pushes on your knee, pull their elbow up, step over the head, and sit back.
- **Cross Collar Choke:** Use the height of the position to reach deep into the collars.
- **Far-Side Americana/Kimura:** Isolating the arm furthest from your knee as they reach to defend their neck.
- **Spinning Armbar:** A dynamic transition where you pivot 180 degrees over the opponent's head to finish on the far arm.

Advance / Transition

- **Windshield Wiper:** Switching the knee from one side of the belly to the other to avoid an escape or change the angle of attack.
- **Mount Transition:** Simply sliding the knee across the body and dropping into **Full Mount**.
- **Back Take:** If the opponent turns away from the pressure, use the space to insert your hooks and transition to **Rear Mount**.

KIN BJJ Overview

Turtle

The **Turtle** is a defensive fortress. In a kids' curriculum, it's important to frame this not just as "hiding," but as a dynamic transition point where the person on top is hunting for an opening and the person on the bottom is looking to explode back to their feet or guard.

Turtle Position

The defensive shell used to prevent guard passes or back takes.

Secure (Top Side)

- **Chest Pressure:** Drive your sternum into the middle of their back to keep them pinned to the mat.
- **The "Seatbelt" or "Power Half":** Secure a seatbelt grip (one arm over, one arm under) or a power half-nelson to control their posture.
- **Blocking the "Exit":** Keep your knees tight against their hips to prevent them from sitting back into Guard or rolling.
- **Weight Distribution:** Stay on your toes (not knees) to keep the "heavy" pressure on their spine.

Attack (Top Side)

- **Clock Choke:** Grip the far lapel and "walk" around their head like the hands of a clock.
- **Rear Naked Choke (RNC):** Fighting the hands to slip the arm under the chin as they try to move.
- **Armbar / Kimura:** If they reach out to grab your leg or arm, isolate that limb and sit back for the finish.
- **Crucifix:** Trapping one arm between your legs while controlling the other arm with your hands.

Advance / Transition

- **Back Take (The Primary Goal):** Inserting hooks or a body triangle to move from Turtle to **Rear Mount**.
- **Truck Transition:** Rolling for the legs to enter into leg entanglements or calf slicers.
- **Breakdown to Side Control:** Pulling the opponent's "near side" arm or ankle to flatten them out into **Side Control**.

KIN BJJ Overview

Escapes

The ability to escape from dominant positions is the single most important skill for a young student's confidence and survival in BJJ. Without solid escapes, all other aspects of the game (Guard, Passing, Submissions) are irrelevant. The focus must be on survival first, creating structure/frames, and then exploding into a re-guard or reversal.

Mount Escape

The most dangerous position to be caught in, emphasizing immediate framing and hip movement.

- **Stabilize:** Establish immediate frames, and if possible, drop a leg to prevent the opponent from locking legs underneath your body. Forearms braced across the hips to prevent the opponent from settling into a High Mount or striking position.
- **Escape/Recover Options:**
    - **Elbow/knee escape (Shrimp):** Use frames on the hip to create space, shrimp the hips away, and slide a knee through to regain Guard.
    - **Kipping escape:** A specialized push against the hips combined with a leg extension to "pop" the opponent's weight off.
    - **Knee lever:** Using the space created by an off-balance opponent to pull the legs back into a Half or Full Guard.
- **Reverse/Transitions:**
    - **Upa escape (Bridge and Roll):** Trap one arm and a foot on the same side, bridge hard, and roll the opponent over their shoulder.
    - Revert to **Closed Guard** or **Half Guard**, or reverse to **Top Side Control** (after a successful Upa).

KIN BJJ Overview

Side Control Escape

Focus on establishing frames and shrimping to create space for the knee to enter to regain guard.

- **Secure/Control:** Use arm frames (forearm on the neck/jaw and forearm on the near-side hip) to maintain distance and prevent chest-to-chest pressure.
- **Attack/Counter-Attack:** Focus is on reversals (Bridge and Roll) or immediately transitioning to a defensive position.
- **Escape Options:**
    - **Hip escape (Shrimp):** Creating space, framing, and shrimping out to insert the knee.
    - **Bridge and roll:** Off-balancing the opponent and rolling them over the shoulder when they transition or apply loose pressure.
    - **Ghost escape:** Sliding under the opponent's armpit and emerging on the opposite side (effective against Modified Side Control/Overhook).
    - **Sit up:** Creating a strong frame and sitting up to face the opponent (effective against loose side control).
    - **Kesa gatame/Reverse Kesa gatame:** Reaching for the head and shrimping out to escape the pin, or kicking your legs away to create a scramble.
- **Advance/Transitions:** Regain **Half Guard** or **Full Guard**, or achieve a **Scramble** to the feet.

KIN BJJ Overview

Rear Mount Escape (Back Control)

Prioritizing hand defense against the choke and clearing the hooks to flatten the opponent.

- **Secure/Control:** Control the choking arm (the one over the shoulder) with both hands (choke defense). Use the head to push the opponent's chest away and prevent them from settling.
- **Attack/Counter-Attack:** If opponent crosses their legs, you lock them with your own legs for a quick leg lock submission
- **Escape Options:**
    - **Bridge and slide (Back to the Mat):** Fighting the seatbelt grip and sliding your back/shoulders to the floor on the side of the opponent's *underhook* (control arm) to neutralize the position into a Deep Half or Guard.
    - **Clear the Hooks:** Use hands and legs to push the opponent's feet down and slide the hips over one of their legs.
- **Advance/Transitions:** Neutralize the position to **Full Guard** or **Deep Half Guard**.

KIN BJJ Overview

Knee on Belly Escape (Knee Ride)

Responding to the high pressure by forcing the opponent to commit their weight or base.

- **Secure/Control:** Use a double frame; one hand pushing the knee, the other framing the hip to prevent the opponent's knee from settling on the solar plexus.

- **Attack/Counter-Attack:** Trapping the leg for a sweep.

- **Escape Options:**
  - **Double frame:** Frame the knee and hip, raise your hips slightly, then shrimp forcefully to pull the knee off the belly to regain guard.
  - **Ankle scoop:** Reaching back to grab the opponent's "kickstand" ankle, pulling them off balance for a sweep/reguard.
  - **Knee clear to granby:** Pushing the knee off, then immediately rolling over the shoulder (Granby) to emerge in Turtle or on top.

- **Advance/Transitions:** Revert to **Half Guard** or execute a **Reversal** to the top.

KIN BJJ Overview

North-South Escape

Focus on frame and movement to avoid chokes and prevent the opponent from transitioning to Side Control.

- **Secure/Control:** Use frames on the hips or neck to push the opponent's weight away. Keep elbows tight to the body. Move the arms inside to prevent chest to chest.

- **Attack/Counter-Attack:**
    - Trap one arm, move offline, and bridge and roll

- **Escape Options:**
    - **Pendulum escape (Rocking Chair):** Swing your legs from side to side to generate momentum, then execute a sit-up to catch a front headlock or double leg.
    - **Hip Frame and Shrimp:** Place hands on their hip bones and push while shrimping your hips backward to create space and bring your knees in.
- **Advance/Transitions:** Revert to **Full Guard** or transition to a **Takedown** attempt from the knees.

KIN BJJ Overview

Turtle Position Escape

Explosive movements designed to turn defense into offense or immediately stand up.

- **Secure/Control:**
  - Maintain a tight defensive shell; keep elbows tucked inside the leg line, chin down, and avoid exposing wrists or neck.

- **Attack/Counter-Attack:**
  - Directly reversing the opponent as they attempt to secure a grip or pass.
  - Grab the outside knee, step over the inside knee. Then walk it to the back corner

- **Escape Options:**
  - **Sit-Through:** Explode out by sliding one leg through the open side to face the opponent or take their back.
  - **Granby Roll:** Rolling over the shoulders to reset into **Full Guard**.
  - **Fat Man Roll:** If the opponent reaches too deep, trapping their arm and rolling them over the shoulder to end up on top.
  - **Stand Up:** Winning the hand fight and exploding back to the feet (Self-Defense priority).

- **Advance/Transitions:**
  - Transition to **Full Guard**, **Takedown** position, or secure a **Back Take** on the opponent.

KIN BJJ Overview

Half Guard Escape

Focus on achieving the underhook and isolating the opponent's top position.

- **Secure/Control:** Turn to the side, get on your hip, and fight aggressively to control the inside position. Keep your top side arm inside your shin shield (knee) to maintain the structure of the position. Keep a shallow hook with your bottom leg, with your knee poking outside opponents legs. The bottom arm prevents cross face and inside hip line.

- **Attack/Counter-Attack:**
  - **Underhook sweep:** Secure underhook, post on your opposite hand, trap the leg, then dive underneath the opponent to roll them to the other side.

- **Escape Options:**
  - **Bridge and shrimp:** Using a strong underhook, bridge to off-balance, and shrimp the hips out to free the trapped leg.
  - **Knee lever:** Using the trapped leg to leverage a reversal as the opponent drives forward. If the opponent posts, insert the underhook as you sweep back to the other hip.
  - **Half butterfly:** Inserting the butterfly hook inside the opponent's thigh to lift and create space for the knee to escape.

- **Advance/Transitions:** Transition to **Full Guard** or a **Sweep/Reversal** to the top

KIN BJJ Overview

In Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu, the Guard is a defensive and offensive ground position where the person on the bottom uses their legs as the primary shield and weapon against an opponent.

While being on the bottom is traditionally a disadvantage in combat, the guard transforms it into a position of control by preventing the opponent from passing to more dominant positions (like Mount or Side Control) and providing a platform for sweeps and submissions.

Guard

Guard work can be broken down into these five distinct phases:

- **Engagement/Grips -** Entry into a guard position where you don't overextend yourself
- **Secure/Control -** Establish grips and contact that allow you to attack opponents posture
- **Retention/Recovery -** Movements and kuzushi used to maintain and retain guard
- **Sweeps -** Offensive cycle attacks, off balancing techniques to land in top position
- **Submissions -** The final step where a match ending technique is applied

Engagement Phase (The Hand-Fight)

Much like in the standing position, you have to win the grip fight before you can secure a guard. This phase is about winning the initial grip fight to prevent your opponent from establishing their preferred passing grips and putting you directly on the defensive cycle.

Focus

- Distance management
- Limiting grip options
- Grip breaking
- Establishing your first point of connection

Secure & Control (Maintain Phase)

This is the "Secure" part you mentioned. Once you have grips, you stabilize the position to prevent the pass and break the opponents posture.

- Focus: Using "stickiness" or connection to keep the opponent in front of you.
- Minimum 3 points of contact
- Continually attacking your opponent's posture

KIN BJJ Overview

Retention & Recovery (Defensive Cycle)

This is the most common missing link in training. If your opponent starts to clear your legs, you must switch from attacking to Retaining Your Guard.

- **Retention**:
  - Keeping the opponent in front of you before they pass the "hip line".
  - Controlling the “inside” position through movements like pummelling
  - Continually attacking your opponents posture and making them carry your weight.
- **Recovery**: Regaining guard after the opponent has almost cleared your legs .
  - Strategies involve high pummeling or inverting

Sweep (Offensive Cycle)

Your goal here is to achieve Kuzushi, or off-balancing, and transition to a top position.

- **Focus**: Removing "posts" (arms or legs) so the opponent cannot stabilize their base as you sweep.
- Create weak corners by removing posts and applying a force in that direction

Submission (The Finish)

The final phase where you use the guard to end the fight via joint locks or chokes. Key points for the finish include:

- Opponent in a compromised position with limited options for posture correction
- Applying submissions once proper control is in place and opponent cannot stack you or remove the limb under attack

KIN BJJ Overview

Closed Guard

Engagement: Pulling guard from standing or transitioning from a failed takedown; wrapping legs around the opponent's waist and crossing ankles.

Secure/Control: Breaking the opponent's posture using a collar-and-sleeve grip or a "top lock" (climbing the legs high over the shoulders).

Retention/Recovery: Regaining the "center line" if the opponent starts to pin one leg or stand up; clearing knees from the hips.

Sweeps:

- **Scissor Sweep:** Creating a frame with one shin across the chest while the bottom leg "kicks" the opponent's base leg.
- **Hip Bump Sweep:** Rising to the elbow/hand to wrap the opponent's arm and driving the hips over.
- **Flower / Pendulum Sweep:** Using leg momentum and a leg-hook to rotate the opponent over the shoulder.

Submissions

- **Triangle:** Trapping one arm and the neck between the legs.
- **Arm Bar:** Isolating an arm and extending the hips against the elbow joint.
- **Omoplata:** A shoulder lock applied using the legs to create internal rotation. The attacker traps the arm and sits up/forward to apply leverage.
- **Cross collar chokes:** Inserting one hand, palm up, deep in the collar to establish the "bite", then using your free hand to establish varied grips (ie-palm up or palm down opposing collar grip) then applying force through leverage to finish

KIN BJJ Overview

Open guard

Engagement: Establishing sleeve grips and placing feet on the opponent's biceps to create tension.

Secure/Control: Maintaining "push-pull" dynamics to keep the opponent's weight off-balance.

Retention/Recovery: Transitioning to Lasso guard or De la Riva if the opponent clears a foot from the bicep.

Sweeps:

- **Balloon Sweep:** Loading the opponent's weight onto your shins/feet and overhead-tossing them.
- **Scissor Sweep:** Standard variation utilizing the sleeve grip for added leverage.
- **Lasso Sweep:** Weave your leg through the opponent's arm and bring your outside foot to your opponent's opposing hip. Grab the leg with the free hand, load your opponent onto you, and sweep to the weak corner.
- **Tripod Sweep:** One hand on the foot, the other on the sleeve or collar of your opponent. One foot should be placed on the hip side with the foot control. Your other leg should be hooked behind the knee or at the ankle. Push with the foot on the hip as the other 3 grips pull to execute sweep. Must follow the opponent up to top position.

Submissions:

- Triangle (set up by shooting the leg over the bicep grip)
- Omoplata
- Arm bar (+ variations)

KIN BJJ Overview

De la Riva / Reverse De la Riva

Engagement: Hooking the outside leg around the opponent's lead leg while holding the heel/ankle.

Secure/Control: Using the non-hooking leg to "push" the far hip or thigh to manage distance.

Retention/Recovery: Inverting to the back or transitioning to "Baby Bolo" if the opponent tries to backstep.

Sweeps:

- **Tripod Sweep:** Pushing the hip while pulling the ankle and hooking the far leg.
- **Sit Up Sweep:** Rising to a single leg position while maintaining the DLR hook.
- **Reverse Sweep:** Utilizing RDLR to off-balance the opponent during a knee-slice pass attempt.
- **Baby Bolo Sweep:** Back take sweep entry from DLR
- **Kiss of the dragon:** Sweep to a back take from RDLR

Submissions:

- Back Take (considered the primary "submission" of the back via the Berimbolo).

Worm Guard (De la Riva Variation)

Engagement: While in De la Riva, feeding the opponent's far-side lapel under their own leg and passing it to your hand that is hooking the lead leg.

Secure/Control: Using the "Worm" lapel grip to create an unbreakable anchor that tethers the opponent’s weight to your hips.

Retention/Recovery: Using the tension of the lapel to prevent the opponent from backing away or passing; if the grip is lost, returning to standard DLR.

Sweeps:

- **Worm Sweep:** Stretching the opponent's base by driving your legs away while holding the lapel, forcing them to the mat.
- **Back Take:** Using the lapel tension to rotate under the opponent’s center of gravity and emerge behind them.

Submissions:

- Lapel-assisted Triangles or transitioning to Leg Attacks.

KIN BJJ Overview

Butterfly / Seated Guard

Engagement: Sitting up with both hooks, (feet), placed inside the opponent's thighs.

Secure/Control: Achieving an overhook/underhook or belt grip to keep the opponent's chest close.

Retention/Recovery: Transitioning to Single Leg X or Full X-Guard if the opponent stands.

Sweeps/transition:

- **Butterfly Sweep:** Using a hook to elevate the opponent while directing them to the side with an overhook.
- **Shin on Shin to X-Guard:** Using the shin to block their lead leg to transition underneath.
- **Elevator sweep to SLX:** Rolling to your back then using both hooks to elevate your opponent to make space for an SLX entry.

Submissions:

- **Guillotine Choke:** As your opponent drives forward to smash your butterfly hooks, you snap their head down or use a "front headlock" grip. Wrap your arm around their neck, fall to your side (the side of the choking arm), and use your butterfly hooks to prevent them from jumping over your guard to escape the pressure.
- **Armbar:** Secure a 2-on-1 grip on their arm or a deep overhook (whizzer). Shift your hips to the side, throw your outside leg over their head, and keep your butterfly hook behind their far thigh to maintain leverage and control their posture as you bridge.
- **Loop Choke:** Get a deep thumb-in grip on the opposite collar. Dive your other hand behind their head or under their arm, "looping" your arm over their neck. As you fall to your side, your butterfly hooks keep them from moving away, increasing the tension of the choke.
- **Omoplata**: Use an overhook to control their shoulder. When they push back, push their face away and swing your leg over their shoulder. You can finish the shoulder lock directly or use the position to transition back into the omoplata sweep.
- **Triangle Choke**: Shoot your legs up when the opponent posts with the outside arm.. The "elevator" action of your butterfly hooks can actually help launch your hips upward to lock the triangle around their neck.

KIN BJJ Overview

Half Guard

Engagement: Trapping one of the opponent's legs between both of yours while on your side.

Secure/Control: Winning the "underhook" and keeping a "shin shield" (knee) between you and the opponent.

Retention/Recovery: "Dog Fight" (coming up to knees) or transitioning to Deep Half/Waiter position.

Sweeps:

- **Old School Sweep:** Reaching for the far toe and driving forward.
- **Electric Chair:** Using a Lockdown to create a submission/sweep hybrid.
- **Deep Half Waiter:** Getting completely underneath the opponent to sweep them over.
- **Underhook rolling sweep**: Come up to a post as you underhook your opponent. Dive your head between their legs as you grab and elevate their knee with the posted arm.
- **John Wayne Sweep**: Whizzer control on the arm and knee lever to the weak side. Push the hip with opposite hand

Submissions:

- Kimura from the bottom

Octopus Guard (Half Guard Variation)

Engagement: From bottom Half Guard, lead with your top side arm and dive your head under the opponent's near arm; climbing your arm over their back to secure a lat grip while remaining posted on your other arm.

Secure/Control: Keeping your chest glued to the opponent's back/side; preventing them from turning back toward you by maintaining a tight over-the-back grip.

Retention/Recovery: If the opponent attempts to sit back or flatten you, transitioning back to a standard Underhook Half Guard or Knee Shield.

Sweeps:

- **Hip Bump Sweep (from Octopus):** Drop your hand to grab their outside foot then drive your hips forward and dump the opponent over their unsupported shoulder.
- **Back Take:** Shifting your hips out and using the lat grip to climb onto the opponent's back.

Submissions: Transitioning to a Rear Naked Choke once the back is taken.

KIN BJJ Overview

Passing

The act of "passing" the guard by transitioning past the legs and securing a pin position. Categorizing passing steps is most effective when organized by direction of movement or mechanical goal rather than just a list of individual moves. This structured approach helps you react logically to an opponent's defense and chain attacks more fluidly.

Categorization by Directional Pathway

Most modern BJJ instructors use three primary "pathways" for categorization:

- **Around the Legs**: Employs speed and agility to circle the opponent's guard before they can establish solid grips. Examples*:* Toreando, X pass, and Leg Drags.
- **Through the Legs**: Involves entering between the opponent's legs to isolate one side while pinning the other. Examples*:* Knee cut, headquarters, split squat, and Long Step pass.
- **Under the Legs:** Uses heavy weight and leverage by going underneath the opponent's legs to stack or compress them. Examples*:* Double under, over-under, and Stack Passes.

Categorization by Hierarchical Progression

Alternatively, steps can be categorized by the phase of the pass, focusing on what you are trying to overcome at that exact moment:

- **Grip Fighting & Opening**: Breaking the opponent's initial connections (e.g., stripping sleeve grips or opening a closed guard).
- **Clearing the Feet:** The "Danger Zone" where the opponent can still establish a new guard; the goal is to get past the soles of their feet.
- **Clearing the Knees**: Getting your hips past their knee line, often by "stapling" a leg or using a knee slide. Getting to the "jeopardy" point at the hip line, effectively separating the upper and lower bodies.
- **Controlling the Hips & Chest**: Consolidating the position by pinning their hips and achieving chest-to-chest contact to prevent guard recovery.

KIN BJJ Overview

Strategy-Based Categories

For more advanced practitioners, categorizing by the intended outcome or style helps in building a cohesive game:

- **Fast/Agility Passing**: Great for smaller grapplers or those with high endurance who want to force reactions.
- **Pressure/Smash Passing**: Ideal for heavier practitioners who want to use gravity and relentless weight to tire the opponent.
- **Submission-Oriented Passing**: Setting up a pass by threatening a submission (like an ankle lock, toe hold or kimura) so they must abandon their guard to defend.

Building a cohesive BJJ passing game involves moving between stable positions from which you can launch multiple attacks based on your opponent's reaction.

The Headquarters System

The most versatile "hub" in modern BJJ. You enter by trapping one of the opponent's legs between your legs while standing or in a combat base.

- Primary Goal: Pin the opponent's hips and limit their guard recovery options.
- The "Hub" Logic:
    - Opponent pushes your knee out: Transition to a Knee cut pass
    - Opponent keeps the knee central/shielded: Transition to a Long Step or Leg Drag to the opposite side.
    - Opponent tries to kick you forward: Use Float Passing by hooking their far leg and moving to mount.
    - Opponent plays deep De La Riva: Clear the hook and "mule kick" back into an X pass.

KIN BJJ Overview

The Standing / Long-Range System

Used primarily against an opponent who has not yet established strong grips or is playing a seated/open guard.

- Primary Goal: Clear the feet (the "danger zone") and bypass the legs.
- Common Sequences:
    - **Toreando (Bullfighter):** Grab the pants/ankles, pull them to one side, and circle past their hips.
    - **X-Pass:** If they block the Toreando, "kick" your lead leg back and punch your arm across their hip to clear the legs.
    - **Leg Drag:** If they try to recover guard by bringing a leg across, catch it and "drag" it across your hip to pin their knees together.
    - **Long step pass:** Control the outside knee and inside collar. Roll your weight forward and take a long back step outside opponents hip line while extending your arm against their knee to maintain distance

The Top Half Guard System

A "smash" hub where you have already bypassed the feet and are working to clear the final leg.

- Primary Goal: Flatten the opponent's shoulders and win the underhook/cross-face battle.
- The "Hub" Logic:
    - **Standard Half Guard**: Secure a far-side underhook and a heavy cross-face, then use your free foot to "pry" their legs open for a Knee Slice.
    - **Opponents use a Knee Shield (Z-Guard)**: Collapse their frame with chest pressure, swallow the knee, and move directly to Mount.
    - **Opponent gets an Underhook:** Use an Over-Under Pass or Backstep to neutralize their leverage and pass to the opposite side.
    - **Switch base pass:** Clear the shin, move weight high onto opponents chest, switch your base and use your free hand to clear the trapped leg

KIN BJJ Overview

The Under-Legs System

Effective against flexible guard players or as a response to triangle/armbar attempts. Pressure is the game here.

- Primary Goal: Compress the opponent's spine by driving their knees toward their chin.
- Common Sequences:
    - **Double Underhooks:** Scoop both legs, lock your hands, and "stack" them onto their neck. Walk your hips around, while maintaining pressure, and clear the legs.
    - **Over-Under:** Trap one leg under your arm and one leg over your shoulder. Use your weight to "kill" their hip mobility before circling.

KIN BJJ Overview

Submission Defense

Submission defense in BJJ consists of technical, proactive, and reactive methods to prevent, avoid, or escape joint locks and chokes, focusing on safety and technical, rather than desperate escapes and movements. It involves anticipating threats, maintaining proper limb positioning, and reducing opponent control to avoid tapping

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Fundamental Defensive Posture

Before technical escapes, students must master "Safety First" habits to prevent submissions from ever locking in. The earlier that you can defend your submission the easier it will be, and alot of the time, having a strong position, and a fundamentally structured base can shut down many submission attempts before they even begin.

- **Active Posture in Guard**: Maintaining a strong spine that is aligned and keeping hands on the opponent's belt or hips to prevent them from breaking the posture for a triangle or armbar. Avoid placing your hands on the mat as it allows your opponent to move underneath you, change the angle, and begin attacking. Weight on the mat is weight not on your opponent.
- **Elbow Discipline:** Training youth to never leave an arm extended which invites posture breaks, submissions, and sweeps. Keeping elbows in limits their options for attacks and keeps you strong. The further your elbows are away from your center, the weaker you become.
- **The Prayer Grip:** Teaching kids to join their hands together (Gable grip or palm-to-palm) the moment a limb is isolated.

Armlock Defense

The IBJJF Rulebook allows straight armbars, Kimuras, and Americanas for almost all youth categories.

- Straight Armbar (from Guard):
    - The "Stack" Escape: Immediately putting weight forward to crush the opponent's hips, preventing them from rotating under you and extending the arm. Drop the elbow and the shoulder to the outside of their hipline, place them on their back, then settle back into your strong base.
    - Hitchhiker Escape: A more advanced rotation escape used when the arm is already partially extended.
- Kimura/Americana Defense:
    - "Hiding" the Hand: Grabbing the inside of their own thigh or gi to deny the opponent the leverage needed to rotate the shoulder.

KIN BJJ Overview

Choke Defense

While collar chokes and Rear Naked Chokes (RNC) are legal, certain variations like the Ezekiel and Guillotine are often restricted for younger children.

- Rear Naked Choke (RNC):
  - Two-on-One Grip: Identifying the "choking arm" and using both hands to pull it down.
  - The "Safe Side" Fall: Falling toward the side of the opponent's bottom arm (the non-choking arm) to make the finish harder.
- Cross Collar Choke (from Guard/Mount):
  - Posture Break: Using the "shrug" and hand-fighting to prevent the second hand from securing the deep grip on the collar.

Triangle Defense

- Stacking Defense: Walking the knees forward and driving the shoulder into the opponent's throat to force them to open their legs.
- Posture and Frame: Creating a frame against the opponent's hip with the free hand to keep the legs from locking.

KIN BJJ Overview

IBJJF Leg Lock Curriculum (Gi & No-Gi)

This curriculum is structured to follow IBJJF Article 6, which strictly prohibits knee reaping and heel hooks in most divisions. The offensive cycle focuses on legal positions (Standard Ashi and Outside Ashi), while the defensive cycle follows the hierarchy of Proactive, Active, and Reactive submission defense.

Offensive Cycle: Legal Entanglements & Finishes

The goal is to secure the joint while maintaining a legal "Knee Line" (keeping your feet on the hips or tucked, never crossing the opponent's midline).

- **White & Blue Belt (Beginner)**
  - Straight Foot Lock: Applied from Standard Ashi Garami. Focus on the "achilles grip" and belly-down transitions.
  - Legal Positioning: Maintaining the outside foot on the hip to avoid "reaping" disqualification.
- **Purple Belt (Intermediate)**
  - Toe Hold: Legal at Purple, Brown, and Black. Focus on the figure-four grip from the top of Half Guard or Side Control.
  - Estima Lock: A high-percentage counter to Open Guard where the opponent's foot is trapped against your chest.
- **Brown & Black Belt (Advanced)**
  - Kneebar: Legal from various entries, including the bottom of Half Guard. Focus on securing the heel to the ear and squaring the hips.
  - Compression Locks: Calf slicers (legal at Brown/Black) used as a transition when the opponent defends the kneebar or back-take.

Defensive Cycle: The Three Stages of Survival

Submission defense relies on identifying the threat before the lever is fully isolated.

- **Proactive Defense (Prevention)**
  - Knee Line Awareness: Preventing the opponent from getting their hips past your knee.
  - Active Toes: Keeping feet flexed to prevent the initial "catch" of an ankle lock or toe hold.
  - Controlling opponents feet so they cannot get a solid purchase on your leg.
- **Active Defense (Early Response)**
  - "The Boot": Flexing the foot hard into the opponent’s armpit to negate the leverage of a straight ankle lock.

- Clearing the Hook: Peeling the opponent's top foot off your hip to break their "Ashi" connection.
- Hand Fighting: Attacking the opponent's primary hand (the one under the heel or ankle) before they can lock their second hand.

- **Reactive Defense (Late Escapes)**
  - The Hitch-hiker Escape: Rotating the hip and "turning the corner" to clear the knee from a kneebar.
  - The Stand-Up: Using your free leg to stand up and put weight on the opponent, killing the angle required for the finish.

IBJJF Legal Guardrails

Important: In IBJJF, intent is often judged by the referee. Ensure all movements are clean.

- No Reaping: Never allow your foot to cross the opponent's far hip while your legs are entangled. Point your toes to the outside.
- Turning Direction: When applying a straight foot lock, always turn toward your outside shoulder; turning toward the inside (reaping direction) is an automatic DQ.
- Toe Hold Direction: The pressure must be toward the opponent’s glute, not a lateral twist that stresses the knee.

KIN BJJ Overview

Takedowns

Takedowns are assembled and categorized based on what is most applicable for BJJ. This is not a comprehensive list of all takedowns, rather a high level overview of techniques that are appropriate. BJJ does not reward high amplitude or high risk takedowns, so each technique needs to be graded based on a matrix of: **ease of learning, ease of execution, reversal risk, and landing/control position.**

Judo Takedowns

Applicable for BJJ; categorized by technique type and ease of learning.

Ashi Waza (Foot Sweeps)

- **Level 1**
  - **Kosoto Gari/Gake (A):** Minor outer reap/hook. A high-efficiency trip focusing on the outside of the ankle.
  - **Kouchi Gari (B):** Minor inner reap. Targeting the heel to trip the opponent backward.
  - **Osoto Gari (C):** Major outer reap. A high-power leg reap pushing the opponent over their own heel.
  -
- **Level 2**
  - **De Ashi Barai (B):** Forward foot sweep. Catching the opponent's foot just as they are about to put weight on it.
  - **Sasae Tsuri Komi Ashi (B):** Propping drawing ankle throw. Blocking the ankle while pulling the opponent over the "trip wire."
  - **Ouchi Gari (C):** Major inner reap. A deep leg reap between the opponent's legs to drive them to their back.

Koshi Waza (Hip Throws)

- **Level 1**
  - **O Goshi (C):** Major hip throw. Stepping deep and loading the opponent's weight across your lower back.
  - **Uki Goshi (D):** Floating hip throw. A more subtle hip bump used when the opponent is moving sideways.
  - **Koshi Guruma (D):** Hip wheel. Using a headlock-style grip to pull the opponent over the hip.
- **Level 2**
  - **Harai Goshi (A):** Outside thigh reap. Sweeping the outside of the opponent's leg while performing a hip throw.

- **Ushiro Goshi (B):** Hip throw reversal. A counter-throw used by lifting an opponent who attempts a hip throw on you.
- **Hane Goshi (C):** Spring hip throw. Using the inside of your thigh to "spring" the opponent upward and over.
- **Utsuri Goshi:** Side hip throw. A complex counter where you switch your hips to lift and throw.

Te Waza (Hand Throws)

- **Level 1**
  - **Tai Otoshi (A):** Body drop. A high-percentage hand throw using a leg prop as a fulcrum.
- **Level 2**
  - **Uchi Mata (A):** Inner thigh throw. A powerful throw using a leg swing between the opponent's legs.
  - **Seoi Nage (B):** Shoulder throw. Variants include:
    - **Ippon Seoi Nage:** One-arm shoulder throw.
    - **Morote Seoi Nage:** Two-handed shoulder throw.
    - **Drop Seoi Nage:** Dropping to both knees to get under the opponent's center of gravity. Drop your shoulder to the mat to facilitate safe completion of the throw.

Sutemi Waza (Sacrifice Throws)

- **Level 1**
  - **Sumi Gaeshi (C):** Corner reversal. Using an overhead hook to flip the opponent over your head.
  - **Uki Waza (C):** Floating throw. A side-sacrifice throw used when the opponent is lunging forward.
- **Level 2**
  - **Tani Otoshi (C):** Valley drop. Dropping behind the opponent to pull them backward over your extended leg. Can be dangerous if not applied properly. Most clubs ban this in the gym. **YOU MUST BE STANDING BEHIND OPPONENT, NOT ON THE SIDE.**
  - **Tomoe Nage (C):** Circle throw. Placing a foot in the hip and rolling backward to launch the opponent over.
  - **Reverse Tai otoshi (B):** From the rear clinch, shift your hands for short/long frames to secure the far side hip. Switch your base to face the rear corner and outstretch your far leg to block the far leg as you drop to your other knee to drag the opponent down. Safer version of Tani Otoshi.

KIN BJJ Overview

Freestyle Wrestling Takedowns

Picks

- **Ankle Pick (A):** Timing a snap-down or a heavy collar tie to reach down and secure the heel while driving forward.

Snaps

- **Snap Down (B):** Using heavy hands on the head/neck to pull the opponent's chest to the mat.
- **Front Headlock:** Controlling the chin and tricep from the snap-down position.
- **Circle to Back:** Navigating around the opponent's arms to secure the waist/back.

Shots

- **Single Leg (A):** Attacking one leg with various finishes:
    - **Inside Hip Line:** Head on the inside of the thigh.
    - **Outside Hip Line:** Head on the outside (High Crotch transition).
    - **Shelf:** Elevating the captured leg onto your own thigh/hip for a finish.
- **High Crotch (B):** An outside shot where you deep-step between the legs and transition to a double leg or lift.
- **Double Leg (A):** Driving through both legs with a change in level to put the opponent on their back.

Drags

- **Arm Drag (A):** Using a cross-wrist and tricep grip to pull the opponent past you, exposing the back.

Greco-Roman Style Takedowns

Clinch Work

- **Front Clinch:** Over-under or double-under control from the front.
- **Rear Clinch:** Securing the waist from behind the opponent.
- **Knee Tap:** Using a clinch to shift weight and blocking the knee with your hand to prevent the opponent from stepping.

KIN BJJ Overview

Trips & Ties

- **Rear Takedown:** Using Tani Otoshi or a reverse Tai Otoshi variation from a clinch.
- **Collar Tie:** Controlling the crown of the head to manipulate posture.
- **Duck Under:** Slipping your head under the opponent's armpit to take the back.
- **Throw By:** Guiding the opponent's momentum past you by moving their arm across your body.
- **Russian Tie:** Two hands controlling one arm of the opponent. Leads to single legs, drags, throw-bys.
- **Russian Tie:** (2-on-1) Controlling one of the opponent's arms with both of yours to set up trips or single legs.

Transitions/Scrambles

Transition based drills can be an exciting way to develop the scrambling skills of the students. For example, begin the students in turtle. Top side looking to secure a pin position or rear mount. Bottom side looking to stand or re-guard.

Remember, movement > moves

Scenario based training.

Statistics show that those who get points on the board first are more likely to win the match. This is especially true at the children's tournaments where timelines are short and refined submission skills are not as developed. Setting up drills where it's a sparring match that stops when the first points are scored. Or down on points and on bottom, the bottom player must submit or stand in remaining time. Etc.

KIN BJJ Overview

Submissions

In Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu, a submission is a tactical finish where one practitioner uses a joint lock or a choke to force their opponent to "tap out," signaling their defeat.

It is the ultimate goal of a BJJ match, as it represents a situation where, in a real fight, the opponent would suffer a broken limb or be rendered unconscious

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The Two Main Types of Submissions

- **Joint Locks**: These techniques involve isolating a specific joint (like the elbow, shoulder, or ankle) and applying leverage to extend or rotate it beyond its natural range of motion. Examples include the Straight Arm Bar (elbow) and the Kimura (shoulder).
- **Chokes (Strangles)**: These techniques apply pressure to the carotid arteries or the airway. This restricts blood flow or oxygen to the brain, leading to temporary unconsciousness if the opponent does not tap. Examples include the Rear Naked Choke and the Triangle Choke

The Mechanism of Ending the Match

- **The Tap Out**: The defender signals they are caught and wishes to stop by tapping their hand twice on the opponent, the mat, or by verbally saying "tap."
- **Technical Submission**: This occurs if the referee stops the match because a practitioner has lost consciousness or sustained a visible injury, even if they did not tap .

Safety and Ethics

In a training environment, the "tap" is a pact of mutual respect. The person applying the submission must release it immediately once the tap occurs to prevent injury. In youth divisions, referees are often trained to stop matches early if a submission is fully locked in to protect growing joints but it is equally important for adults to take personal responsibility to protect their own joints.

As BJJ is a marathon, not a sprint, we must limit the amount of damage we incur as it adds up over a long career. It's not just the catastrophic injuries that we need to watch, but the small repetitive damage that becomes cumulative over time. Ultimately, you are responsible for your own well being, so protect yourself at all times. **TAP OFTEN, TAP EARLY!**

KIN BJJ Overview

From The Guard (Bottom)

- Straight Arm Bar: Isolate the arm and bridge hips toward the elbow. This is a fundamental technique allowed across all youth age groups.
- Triangle Choke: Using the legs to trap the head and one arm. IBJJF Safety Standard: For athletes under 16, pulling on the head to increase pressure is prohibited.
- Kimura: Applying a figure-four grip on the arm to control the shoulder. This is permitted for all youth divisions.
- Cross Collar Choke: Utilizing the lapels for a controlled choke. This is a basic technique allowed for all ages.
- Omoplata: Using the legs to apply pressure to the shoulder. IBJJF Safety Standard: This is prohibited as a submission for athletes under 13; it can only be used as a transition or sweep.

From The Mount

- Americana: Controlling the wrist and elbow to create a shoulder lock. This is allowed for all ages.
- Straight Arm Bar: Transitioning from the mount position to the arm-extension finish. This is allowed for all ages.
- Cross Collar Choke: Applying a lapel choke while maintaining the top mount position. This is allowed for all ages.

From Side Control

- Paper Cutter Choke: Using a lapel grip and forearm pressure. This is a standard submission allowed for all ages.
- Kimura: Utilizing the figure-four grip when an opponent attempts to escape side control. This is allowed for all ages.
- Americana: Controlling the wrist and elbow to create a shoulder lock. This is allowed for all ages.

From the Back (Rear Mount)

- Rear Naked Choke: Finishing the choke with a seatbelt grip and chest-to-back pressure. This is allowed for all youth divisions.
- Sliding Collar Choke: Using the opponent's lapel to apply a choke from the back. This is allowed for all ages.
- Bow and Arrow Choke: Controlling the leg while applying a lapel choke from the back. This is allowed for all ages.

KIN BJJ Overview

Techniques Strictly Prohibited for Youth Athletes (Under 16)

- Leg Locks: All twisting leg locks, including heel hooks and toe holds, are strictly prohibited and result in immediate disqualification.
- Straight Ankle Locks: These are not permitted until the athlete reaches age 16 and the Blue Belt rank.
- Wrist Locks: These are prohibited for all athletes under the age of 16.
- Neck Cranks: Any technique that applies pressure to the cervical spine without a choke is strictly prohibited.
- Guillotine Chokes: Restricted in younger age brackets under 16 to protect the neck.
- Ezekiel Chokes: Using the sleeve to apply pressure to the neck is restricted in many youth divisions.
- Triangle: Acceptable but no pulling on the head until 16.

Look at the chart listed within this document for allowable and prohibited submissions based on age or rank or use the link below for the IBJJF website:

https://ibjjf.com/